

PROJECT INITIALIZATION & PLANNING PHASE

Defining Customer Problem Statements

1. Overview & Purpose

A well-articulated customer problem statement allows you and your team to find the ideal solution for your customers' challenges. Creating clear problem statements helps teams remain strictly focused on what matters most, guiding the design of highly meaningful experiences that people will love.

Throughout this process, you will also be able to deeply empathize with your customers. This empathetic connection provides essential insights into how they truly perceive your product, service, or workflow system.

Core Objective: To construct a reliable framework that captures the customer's point of view, breaking down their objectives, constraints, underlying justifications, and direct emotional responses.

2. The Customer Problem Statement Template

The standard problem statement is constructed by linking together five sequential parameters to form a cohesive perspective:

I am...	Customer/Persona: Defines who the specific user or applicant is.
I'm trying to...	Action/Goal: Outlines what the customer is actively attempting to accomplish.
But...	Obstacle/Constraint: Identifies the primary bottleneck or friction point hindering progress.
Because...	Reason/Context: Explains the specific operational context or background reason.
Which makes me feel...	Emotion/Impact: Gauges the resulting state of mind or emotional experience.

3. Worked Reference Case (PS-1)

Below is the baseline reference scenario documenting a standard property loan applicant evaluation:

ID	I am (Customer)	I'm trying to	But	Because	Which makes me feel
PS-1	A male applicant seeking a loan.	Secure a loan for the property.	Married with no co-applicant income.	Self-employed with a good credit history.	Optimistic about loan approval.

4. Interactive Practice Workspace

Utilize the structure above to synthesize your own dynamic project problem statement. Ensure that each component links logically to highlight user frustrations and design opportunities.

[Practice Space: Formulate your user persona constraints and scenario criteria here]